

Gatepost Partners is building a **coalition of commercial kitchen hood cleaning, grease trap, and compliance companies along the East Coast**. We are combining forces with independent operators, each joining as a partner, to grow an operator network with the density, accounts, and buying power no single shop can reach alone. Owners receive cash at closing, **roll equity into the combined company** as partners, and keep their name on the truck and their crew on the routes. Our equity is committed before a letter of intent is signed.

INVESTMENT APPROACH

FOUNDING PARTNER

\$500k to \$3mm

EBITDA, on \$2.5mm to \$17mm revenue

PARTNER COMPANIES

\$0.5mm to \$2mm

Revenue, joining the platform

TRANSACTION

Majority Recap

Equity rolled into the platform

MANAGEMENT

A True Partnership

Encouraged to stay and grow

PILLARS OF PARTNERSHIP



Shared ownership

Every owner rolls equity into the combined company and owns a piece of what we build together.



Local roots

Your name stays on the truck, and your crew and the kitchens they serve stay with you.



Strength in numbers

Chain and institutional account development, systems, and buying power that a single shop can't afford alone.



Density together

Neighboring partners add kitchens on the same nights, lifting productivity for everyone.



Careers, not just jobs

Technicians and managers gain IKECA-track training, pay growth, and room to advance.

HOW IT WORKS



01 The first partner

Leaders stay on as partners. The crew and name stay.



02 Neighbors join

Adjacent operators add kitchens on the same nights.



03 Grow together

Shared scheduling, documentation, and buying power.

THE PLATFORM BRINGS

- + Chain, hotel, and institutional accounts
- + Scheduling that contracts the calendar
- + Technician pay, training, and careers
- + Back office, permits, and documentation

WHAT STAYS YOURS

- ✓ Your name and phone number
- ✓ Your crew and your routes
- ✓ A role if you want one
- ✓ Partnership equity

TARGET SERVICES

Hood and Exhaust

- Hood, plenum, and duct to bare metal
- Rooftop and in-line fan service
- Rooftop grease containment and filters

Grease Trap and Interceptor

- Scheduled trap pumping
- In-ground interceptor service
- Line jetting, FOG manifests, cooking oil

Kitchen Safety and Compliance

- Exhaust fan repair
- Suppression inspection coordination
- Make-up air, HVAC, multi-site reporting

ABOUT OUR FOUNDER

Chris Kern founded Gatepost Partners to build a coalition of commercial kitchen safety companies alongside the owners who join it. He runs a residential water treatment business, which taught him what a small service company depends on: a technician who shows up, a phone someone answers, and route density. Before that, he spent a handful of years at a lower middle market private equity firm on platform buyouts and add-on acquisitions of founder and family-owned companies, running diligence and financing through closing and working with management teams on budgets, KPIs, and integration. Chris is an MBA candidate at The Wharton School, holds a B.S. in Finance from Florida State University, and plans to move to the market and run the platform day to day.